

TDK (6762.T): Components strategy briefing and plant tour highlight corporate culture, competitive edge, and growth potential for AI; Buy

We toured three TDK sites on September 11: the Honjo Plant (MLCCs), the Sakata Plant (wire-wound common mode filters), and the Tsuruoka East Plant (thin-film inductors). We also attended a business strategy briefing by the CEO of the Electronic Components Business Company. Below we outline details by business at each site.

We think the “TDK United” corporate culture has penetrated through to the manufacturing floor, as seen in vertically integrated end-to-end production (vertical alignment), horizontal deployment of know-how (horizontal alignment), and initiatives to combine capacities in materials and core technologies with products and sales channels. We think these initiatives are underpinning unique competitiveness, enabling TDK to provide value to a broad range of areas in the AI ecosystem, and leading to improved growth potential and profitability across many product groups. Our impression from the tour is positive. We think TDK’s electronic components business, driven mainly by AI applications, will fuel earnings growth, and we maintain our Buy rating.

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Electronic components business as a whole

(1) Manufacturing capabilities: Mass production quality, supply capabilities, and profitability are improving thanks to vertical and horizontal connections, such as a vertically integrated end-to-end production system and the sharing of know-how between businesses. Domestic manufacturing divisions in this business are being integrated beyond the boundaries of products and locations, and TDK is working to secure the adaptability of human resources and other assets as the business portfolio changes.

(2) Combinations: Diverse products are being created by combining materials and core technologies, and powerful proposal capabilities are generated by further combining these products and sales channels. In addition to AI/data center applications, TDK is proposing ways to use electronic components for new AI devices in areas such as autonomous driving and robotics.

(3) Production capacity: Amid expanding business opportunities for AI applications, we estimate based on this briefing that, assuming production capacity (volume basis) in FY3/26 at 100, TDK intends to expand capacity over FY3/27-FY3/29 as follows: for MLCCs, from c.105 -> c.125 -> c.150; for aluminum electrolytic capacitors (AI/data center uses), from c.200 -> c.400 -> c.700; for

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thin-film inductors, from c.100 -> c.150 -> c.210; and for EMC filters, from c.105 -> c.115 -> c.120.

MLCCs

(1) Business strategy: With voltages moving higher in data center power supply systems, TDK is seeing an increase in orders for the high voltage tolerance and high reliability products in which it has built up a track record in automotive applications. In addition, heat resistance is becoming more important near GPUs due to increased power consumption, and TDK aims to expand sales in the high temperature tolerance and high reliability field. In automotive applications as well, it expects steady demand growth on the back of an increasing EV ratio and development of EV infrastructure.

(2) Honjo Plant: An end-to-end production system has been built on a single floor. Many of the facilities are manufactured in-house, and the company's accumulated technologies are being utilized; for example, the carrier tape used to transport ceramic sheets inherited technology from TDK's know-how in cassette tapes.

Wire-wound common mode filters

(1) Business strategy: Backed by high reliability and production efficiency (= cost advantage), TDK products have become the de facto standard for automotive applications. The company also has its own patented wire-winding technology, responding to the acceleration of connected cars, including ADAS. Automotive communication technologies are also being more widely applied in humanoid robots, and there is potential for this to become a new growth market for the company.

(2) Sakata Plant: Production capacity has expanded c.3X compared to 10 years ago. DX initiatives were highlighted during this tour, and we saw how the defect rate and utilization rate by line, by equipment, and by item are being seen in real time.

Thin-film inductors

(1) Business strategy: Major applications include automotive, AI/data centers, smartphones, and wearables. In response to the need for miniaturization in AI/data centers, the company looks for an increase in products for vertical power delivery, including optical transceivers and IVRs (integrated voltage regulators embedded in package substrates).

(2) Tsuruoka East plant: TDK supplies low-profile, high-current-capable, and low-loss products through a unique manufacturing method that applies thin-film technology (photolithography, plating, materials, etc.) derived from HDD heads.

Other highlights included (1) for aluminum electrolytic capacitors, the introduction of a new aluminum foil processing method has enabled increased capacitance and strengthened competitiveness, and (2) for SSTs, TDK is poised for business opportunities in various components, including transformers and film capacitors.

TDK

Price Target Risks and Methodology - TDK

Valuation methodology: We are Buy rated on TDK with a 12-month price target of ¥4,900. Our target price is based on a FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying a 10% premium to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 10X (implies FY3/28E P/E of 27X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, higher input costs, and yen appreciation.

6762.T	12m Price Target: ¥4,900	Price: ¥2,809	Upside: 74.5%
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Buy	GS Forecast				
Market cap: ¥5.3tr / \$34.6bn Enterprise value: ¥4.9tr / \$32.0bn 3m ADTV: ¥39.8bn / \$248.6mn Japan Japan Electronic Components/Semiconductors M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	Revenue (¥ bn)	3/26 2,504.8	3/27E 3,009.5	3/28E 3,219.0	3/29E 3,456.5
	Op. profit (¥ bn)	272.4	358.0	398.0	440.0
	Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	265.0	295.0	—	—
	EPS (¥)	103.1	153.8	165.5	183.5
	P/E (X)	19.1	18.3	17.0	15.3
	P/B (X)	1.8	2.2	2.0	1.8
	Dividend yield (%)	1.8	1.3	1.4	1.4
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(0.6)	(0.7)	(1.0)	(1.3)
	CROCI (%)	15.7	17.5	20.5	22.4
		6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
	EPS (¥)	42.5	46.5	39.9	24.9

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 11 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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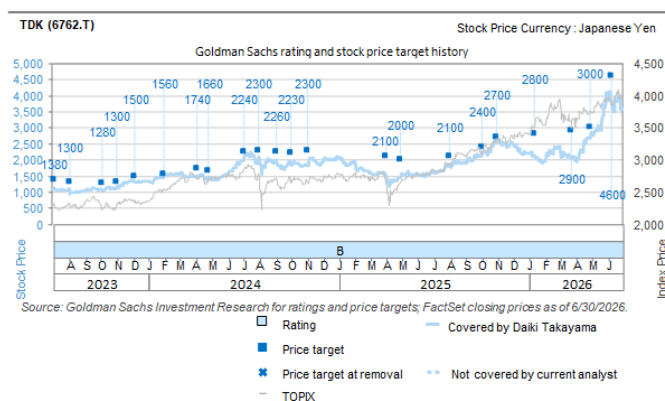
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TDK (6762.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-Jul-26	4,900	3,008
08-Jun-26	4,600	3,715
28-Apr-26	3,000	2,677
23-Mar-26	2,900	2,043
12-Jan-26	2,800	2,142
31-Oct-25	2,700	2,673
02-Oct-25	2,400	2,154
01-Aug-25	2,100	1,876
28-Apr-25	2,000	1,460
31-Mar-25	2,100	1,546
01-Nov-24	2,300	1,848
01-Oct-24	2,230	1,948
02-Sep-24	11,300	2,023
30-Jul-24	11,500	2,029
02-Jul-24	11,200	2,004
26-Apr-24	8,300	1,462
03-Apr-24	8,700	1,488
31-Jan-24	7,800	1,488
06-Dec-23	7,500	1,338
01-Nov-23	6,500	1,158
04-Oct-23	6,400	1,052

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